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Elaine Brown Issues Statement At N.Y. Convention

“THE DEMOCRATIC PARTY HAS ABANDONED BLACK PEOPLE”



Racist Georgia delegate at 1924 Democratic Convention (left). In her statement on the 1976 Convention, BPP chairperson Elaine Brown stressed that, “The Democratic Party... has abandoned Black people, working people and all the oppressed and disenfranchised people of this country. . . .”

The following statement was issued by Ms. Elaine Brown, chairperson and leading member of the Black Panther Party, on July 15, 1976. The statement was issued in New York City, where Elaine was an official delegate to the Democratic National Convention from California.

“The Democratic Party has taken a clear turn to the right and has abandoned Black people, the working people and all the oppressed and disenfranchised people of this country. It is time the Black people, the working people and all oppressed and disenfranchised people abandon the Democratic Party. It is time the Black people, the working people and all the oppressed and disenfranchised people build a political party of their own.

“I am ashamed of a number of Black people who are delegates to this Democratic Convention, led by a new breed of Uncle Toms like Andrew Young and Jesse Jackson, who have embraced the reactionary scheme of Jimmy Carter and the theme of this Convention.

“At this Convention there are less Blacks and less women than in 1972. There has been no discussion of any of the important issues facing the people of this country. The platform is shaky, mealy-mouthed rhetoric that does not represent anything practical. The Democratic Party and its leadership have refused to seriously address the real questions of unemployment, the problems of the urban crisis and the most important issues facing the working people, the Blacks, the Native

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